Daniel Khalili

Engineering Manager | 10+ Years Software Engineering | Ad Tech | Agentic AI | Full-Stack
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Product-minded engineering manager with 10+ years of software engineering experience, deep platform experience, and a track record of leading teams through complex, business-critical product and infrastructure work. Formal Engineering Manager since January 2026, with earlier leadership experience across team management, hiring, mentoring, roadmap ownership, and product/technical direction in Tech Lead, startup, and co-founder roles.

NOTABLE INITIATIVES

- **Ad Manager MCP:** Co-founded the Ad Manager MCP at Kargo, integrating core ad operations workflows into MCP-compatible infrastructure. Extended the system into developer workflows for code-context-aware testing, analysis, monitoring, and fix generation across real ad operations workflows.
- **Multi-Surface Ad Architecture:** Led and presented the architectural framework to expand Kargo's ad format hierarchy beyond OpenWeb to support CTV, In-App, DOOH, and OS Native surfaces. Started internally, adopted by a dedicated surfaces team, now a high-priority executive initiative.
- **Deployment Transformation:** As Tech Lead, drove the shift from large bi-weekly deployments with recurring incidents to weekly releases with minimal failure rates across a broader team of roughly 10 engineers. Improved speed without sacrificing stability.
- **Jira and GitHub Automation:** Built a webhook-driven workflow layer connecting GitHub, Jira, release metadata, PR labels, alerts, and engineering comms. The system synchronized tickets to PRs, generated release notes, surfaced workflow state, and helped engineers move from code context to operational action without leaving the development loop.
- **Bidding Strategy and Curation:** Led the integration of bidding strategy and curation capabilities into the platform and coordinated rollout across the company.
- **CTV Subject Matter Expert:** Served as the cross-departmental SME for CTV integrations at Kargo, bridging engineering, ad operations, and supply teams to expand campaign management to the connected TV surface.
- **AI Adoption:** Led AI integration within the engineering team and expanded tooling and workflows to other departments. Built internal agentic systems using Cursor, OpenAI API, Anthropic API, Neuron AI, and Laravel AI Toolkit to improve developer velocity, automate engineering operations, and support production workflows.

EXPERIENCE

Kargo New York, NY

Primary ad demand and supply management platform for a 500-800 person organization. The platform and APIs power campaign management, publisher supply, and new ad tech integrations company-wide, processing thousands of requests daily across multiple repositories, tech stacks, and business domains.

Manager, Engineering Jan 2026 - Present

- Promoted into engineering leadership while remaining hands-on technically, balancing high-level planning with active development
- Primary point of contact between Product, Project Managers, and Engineering leadership across major initiatives, gathering requirements, aligning on business outcomes, and driving implementation under real resource constraints
- Manage 4 direct reports through 1:1s, career growth conversations, structured feedback, and thoughtful task assignment
- Assign tasks based on individual strengths and development areas, and provide direct feedback to help engineers grow
- Key voice in roadmap planning, proposing and scoping initiatives for cycle and quarterly planning in close collaboration with Product
- Run sprint ceremonies including standups and technical deep-dives
- Coordinate cross-team dependencies and communicate timelines to leadership and dependent stakeholders
- Bring a product mindset to engineering leadership, focused on outcomes and company-wide impact

Senior Software Engineer II | Tech Lead Jan 2024 - Jan 2026

- Led full-lifecycle development of the internal Campaign Management platform, owning end-to-end delivery across distributed backend services, low-latency APIs, and greenfield frontend applications.
- Designed, built, and operated core platform services and internal tools supporting campaign management, with a focus on low-latency APIs, permissions, monitoring, logging, alerts, and reliable service boundaries.
- Operated as the team’s technical and delivery lead while being evaluated for formal engineering leadership, owning team coordination, mentoring, execution planning, stakeholder communication, and delivery quality across a broader group of roughly 10 engineers

- Built internal engineering automation across GitHub, Jira, release notes, PR metadata, alerts, and team communications, using webhook-driven workflows, clear service contracts, and reliability safeguards to reduce manual coordination and improve delivery visibility.
- Gathered and translated business and product requirements into technical solutions, managing priorities across concurrent workstreams while navigating constant context switching
- Ran code reviews, managed CI/CD deployments, and established engineering best practices across the team
- One of the primary mentors on the team, actively supporting engineer growth and knowledge sharing
- Early adopter of AI tooling within the team, integrating tools that significantly accelerated delivery without compromising code quality
- Stack: PHP (Laravel), Node.js, React, Angular, Inertia.js, Docker, AWS, Kubernetes

Senior Software Engineer I Dec 2021 - Jan 2024

- Joined Kargo's Workflow team as a senior engineer and quickly took ownership of initiatives end-to-end across multiple repositories and tech stacks
- Built across the full stack including backend services, APIs, and frontend interfaces supporting internal operations and ad-serving workflows
- Learned new technologies and business logic continuously to keep pace with an evolving, multi-platform environment
- Contributed to code reviews and helped raise overall code quality across the team

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YLift Team New York, NY

Senior Software Engineer | Tech Lead Sep 2020 - Dec 2021

- Hired, managed, mentored, and reviewed a team of 3 engineers while owning product direction, technical architecture, and delivery planning with the CEO
- Built and led the tech department from the ground up for a medical aesthetics e-commerce company, modernizing the platform to a new generation of technology
- Led the architecture and development of a live streaming and class platform for healthcare training and procedure demonstrations, evolving it from basic video conferencing into a full-featured communication and learning environment using AWS ChimeSDK and FFmpeg
- Worked directly with the CEO to set company direction and shape the product roadmap
- Stack: Node.js, Vue.js, MySQL, Elasticsearch, Docker, AWS (EC2, ECS, S3, CodePipeline, ChimeSDK)
- Set engineering priorities, coordinated execution, and made product and technical tradeoff decisions under fast-moving startup constraints

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SpotLeads Remote | Freelance

Back-End Developer Mar 2019 - Sep 2020

- Built and managed RESTful APIs for a real estate mobile startup using Node.js, Firebase, and MongoDB on AWS, collaborating directly with iOS developers

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Scimund Inc Brooklyn, NY

Co-Founder | Architect | Lead Software Engineer May 2017 - Jun 2019

- Built a technology startup focused on immersive VR and media experiences for capturing and reliving personal memories
- Co-founded the company and led software/product direction under startup constraints, managing team execution, stakeholder expectations, technical decisions, and rapid delivery across web and immersive platforms
- Served as one of two company leads, making product direction and project management decisions alongside day-to-day engineering and operations
- Managed the software department, including hiring, budgeting, team oversight, architecture, and development across web and VR platforms
- Built in-house server infrastructure to connect web applications and led the team into new technology including Unreal Engine, Unity, C++, and Python

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Zola Suite Port Washington, NY

Front-End Developer Nov 2016 - May 2017

- Built frontend features and RESTful APIs for legal practice management software using JavaScript, C#, Bootstrap, and MongoDB

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership: Engineering Management, Technical Leadership, Roadmap Planning, 1:1s, Career Development, Cross-functional Collaboration, Service Ownership

Languages: PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Ruby, C#, C++, HTML, CSS

Frameworks & Runtimes: Laravel, Node.js, React, Angular, Vue.js, Inertia.js, Next.js, Express.js, Bootstrap

AI Tools: Cursor, Claude, GitHub Copilot, OpenAI Codex, CodeRabbit, OpenAI API, Anthropic API, MCP, Neuron AI, Laravel AI Toolkit

Cloud & Infra: AWS (EC2, ECS, S3, CodePipeline, CloudWatch, ChimeSDK), Docker, Kubernetes, Elasticsearch, Redis, CI/CD Pipelines

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite, Firebase

Dev Tools: GitHub, Jira, Asana, Webhook Automation, Service Contracts

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Stony Brook University 2011 - 2015
Stony Brook, NY

General Assembly | Web Development Immersive Jul 2015 - Sep 2015
New York, NY